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The IT industry is highly knowledge- and competency-driven and therefore, technology requirements change every three years. Given this backdrop, there is a constant demand from customers for new skills. This means that companies like TCS recognise the importance of new certifications and continuously invest to develop the competencies of its associates.

A strong academic record forms an important eligibility criterion in our selection process, especially for fresh entrants. While recruiting experienced professionals, certain skill-specific certifications can help give a person an edge over competitors for the job.

Normally, not many freshers obtain high-end certifications typically covered by our certification policy. Those who do have some certifications have an edge over other applicants. Certifications reflect the initiative of a candidate and his urge to keep learning. This edge is important, given the kind of competition that exists to get a job with a preferred employer like TCS.



ARE CERTIFICATION

When it comes to recruitment, different companies treat certifications—such as MCSE or CCNE—differently. Some say it is important; some say it *might* make a difference; some attach no weightage to such courses. Here's what five HR officials have to say



Eli Ramon
HR director, South Asia
Intel

Certifications are relevant for certain types of jobs because they bridge the gap between conventional education and specific skill requirements. If you looked at specialised professions like medical, legal, insurance etc., certifications have been pretty much the norm. Specific to the IT industry, we see some commonly preferred certifications like PMP for Project Managers, Cisco and Microsoft certifications. Networking, database, Unix/Linux, information security, and technologies like ERP, data warehousing, storage, and supply-chain are the common areas.

A certification does tell me that this candidate is interested enough and serious enough about the profession to put in extra effort. But that's just a foot in the door. The hiring decision is eventually based on demonstrated knowledge and the quality of experience they have gained.

When we assess recent college graduates, we focus on basics. For us, the key factors are aptitude, verbal ability, reasoning, value system, and technical knowledge related to what they learnt in their stream of education. Certifications may help them improve scores on those, but cannot make all the difference.

A degree can be valuable, certification can be valuable, but in the final analysis, you should really know your stuff in-depth. If you are absolutely clear what area you want to work on, certification will be valuable.